PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (**http://bmjopen.bmj.com/site/about/resources/checklist.pdf**) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	Food handling practice and associated factors among food handlers in public food establishments of Ethiopia: A systematic review and Meta-analysis
AUTHORS	Meseret, Maru; Dagnew, Amare; Alamirew, Dehabo

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Boatemaa, Sandra University of Ghana
REVIEW RETURNED	21-Jun-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	Abstract Line 20. Use another word ‘getaway’ it is informal Line 20-22 sentence is clear. Can be turned into two Line 43: 100% is reducdant, delete

REVIEWER	Illés, Csaba Hungarian University of Agriculture and Life Sciences
REVIEW RETURNED	13-Oct-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	The main aim of the manuscript is to pool the level of good food handling practice among food handlers working in public food establishments in Ethiopia. The topic itself is important as foodborne diseases represent huge hazards all over the world, and food handling is heavily important for a developing country in Africa. The topic could raise the attention of scholars of this topic, but it will neeed major revisions for recommending for publication. Reviewers notes: 1. The aim of the research shall be defined more clearly. Please define who are the adressees of the article? Wide public? Researchres? Practicioners? Who will learn from the results? 2. It is not original research but literature review article – it has no empirical research and primary survey, it uses PROSPERO international database. The type of article shall be changed for "literature review article" 3. It has no clear headings and subheadings. Please reconstruct to have better structure. 4. As written in the manuscript: „The assessment was performed by two reviewers namely Mr. Amare Dagnew and Ms. Dehabo Alamirew.”

	This is not related to the content of the main body of the article, it can be a note at the end. 5. Conclusions are very general in this form and they do not related to the results and the original aim of the research. Outcomes should be clearly defined in Conclusions, too.

REVIEWER	Cruz-Cano, Raul University of Maryland, Epidemiology and Biostatistics
REVIEW RETURNED	18-Dec-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	I don't have much to say given the excellent work that the authors did all around. This is especially true when it came to the statistical analysis methods (which are appropriate and well applied in this project) and the selection of the studies included in this meta-study. I was worried about the quality of the material that was going to be available to the authors (at first glance the research area appears to be a bit niche) but it seems that they were able to find enough studies with good sample size and adequate selection techniques to convince me that their final results are valid. Moreover, the studies come a diversity of areas from all over the country so their conclusions can in fact be generalized to whole country of Ethiopia. Finally, the limitations mentioned in their submission make it clear to the readers any other problems that they need to keep an eye on when deciding how much weight should be given to this manuscript. A few areas of improvement: (1) The connection between food-handling and food-borne disease prevalence is obvious but should be better recognized and supported with references. (2) The meaning of the columns Q1-Q8 is not clear. (3) It might be better to relegate a few figures, e.g. Figure 4, to supplements to keep the main text focused on the results of the study instead of the study selection process. I'm not questioning the value of the conclusions that can be extracted from the figures, my suggestions is just to mention these conclusions in the text and move the figures (which consume a large amount of space) to an appendix.

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

All of the comments given by each of the reviewers are addressed well. However, we can not amend the comment given on the type of article to review because there is an option there!!!

VERSION 2 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Illés, Csaba Hungarian University of Agriculture and Life Sciences
REVIEW RETURNED	20-Jan-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	Authors addressed all of my comments and the other reviewer's and editor's notes. In this improved form the manuscript is recommended for publication.

REVIEWER	Cruz-Cano, Raul University of Maryland, Epidemiology and Biostatistics
REVIEW RETURNED	06-Jan-2022

GENERAL COMMENTS	My recommendations have been addressed satisfactorily by the authors and I don't have any more comments about this manuscript submission.